Designing a Gamified Application for User Privacy Preference Extraction

Continual Assessment Report

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Abstract

[Write this after the main sections are drafted.]

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Chapter 1

Introduction

1.1 Background

Even in this day and age of absurd technological advancements, user privacy preference remains an alien topic for the general public. There are several ways user privacy preferences can be collected online, some common ways that are used may be through surveys [1], device settings parsing [2], and cookies' consent banner interaction [3]. This project will specifically be exploring how user privacy preferences are extracted through cookies, commonly presented to users with the interface of a popup provided by CMPs (Consent Management Platforms) called cookie banners [4] each time they visit a website.

Most people don't really pay close attention to the user privacy preferences that they (have to) set each time they visit a new website on the Internet and is presented with a cookie banner. Whenever people are presented with a popup-like interface with verbose texts that they have to read through, the instinct for most people would be to get rid of the popup window. As such when combined with the assumption that the general public isn't sufficiently educated on the topic of the importance of user privacy preferences and how to manage them well, users tend to click the options presented on the interface that allows them to proceed immediately (i.e. usually the "Accept All" or "Deny All" options). Some reasons why people tend to ignore how user privacy preference extraction works in cookie banners is likely driven by the cookie banners' deliberately complex design and users' knowledge limitations [5].

In view of this problem presented and potential causes that are established, this project aims to solve this issue by gamifying the process of user privacy preference extraction through cookie banners.

1.2 Project Objectives

Given the background of the project, the project aims to address the problems through primarily 3 objectives:

1. Investigate existing solutions that attempts to address similar issues
2. Design a solution that presents the management of cookies in a gamified interface
3. Evaluate how a gamified process may be effective in helping users manage their privacy preferences within their own initiative

With these 3 objectives as the foundational directive pointers for this report, the report will be detailing how the solution for this project came to ideation, the project's progress so far and it's subsequent analysis on how effective it is in achieving the objectives.

1.3 Ideation of Solution

Before constructing the ideation of this project's solution, it is useful to understand where the current practice stands and specifically how does most websites collect user's cookie consent preferences.

1.3.1 Review of Current Cookie Consent Practices

1.3.2 Requirements

1.3.3 Constructing the Solution

Addressing the Requirements

1.3.4 Constraints

Chapter 2

Literature Review

2.1 Review approach

[Describe where and how you searched, search terms, date range, and how you selected sources.]

2.2 Key themes

2.2.1 [Theme 1]

[Compare and synthesize relevant studies; do not just summarize one paper per paragraph.]

2.2.2 [Theme 2]

[Explain agreements, differences, limitations, and what remains unresolved.]

2.3 Research gap and implications for this project

[Show how the reviewed work motivates your objectives and design choices.]

Chapter 3

Progress to Date

3.1 Work completed

[Describe completed investigation, requirements, implementation, or other evidence of progress.]

3.2 Design or investigation alternatives

[Present plausible alternatives and compare them against clear criteria. A table can help.]

Table 3.1: Example comparison of alternatives (replace with your own).

Criterion	Alternative A	Alternative B
[Criterion]	[Evidence / trade-off]	[Evidence / trade-off]

3.3 Preliminary design or investigation

[Describe the current preferred direction, why it was selected, assumptions, and open questions.]

3.4 Challenges and risks

[Explain issues encountered and what you did or will do about them.]

Chapter 4

Research Plan for Next Semester

4.1 Planned work and methods

[List the remaining activities, methods, tools, and expected outputs.]

4.2 Milestones

Table 4.1: Provisional next-semester plan. Replace weeks with actual dates.

Period	Activity	Output
Weeks 1–2	[Refine design / protocol]	[Approved plan]
Weeks 3–5	[Build / collect / investigate]	[Intermediate result]
Weeks 6–8	[Evaluate / analyze]	[Evaluation findings]
Weeks 9–12	[Refine and write up]	[Final report / demonstration]

4.3 Evaluation and success criteria

[State how you will judge whether objectives have been met and what evidence you will collect.]

Chapter 5

Conclusion

[Briefly recap the problem, progress, current direction, and immediate next steps.]

References

[1] H. Asif and J. Vaidya, "A study of users' privacy preferences for data sharing on symptoms-tracking/health app," in *Proceedings of the [conference name]*, Nov. 2022, pp. 109–113. DOI: 10.1145/3559613.3563202

[2] *TipUp: Managing your privacy settings*, en.

[3] Y. Cao, W. Zhang, and C. Han, "How to enhance user privacy via transparent cookie statements," in *Proceedings of the 2025 International Conference on Machine Learning and Neural Networks*, Chongqing China: ACM, Apr. 2025, pp. 336–342.

[4] https://usercentrics.com/knowledge-hub/guide-what-is-a-cmp/, Accessed: 2026-10-30.

[5] Safna, *Cookie consent psychology: What makes users say yes or no?* en, https://www.cookieyes.com/blog/cookie-consent-psychology/, Accessed: 2026-10-30, Jun. 2025.